

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 740

By Carringer

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Dogwood Arts upon the occasion of its seventieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is the privilege of the members of this General Assembly to recognize those venerable cultural institutions that exist to foster and perpetuate the arts and enrich the places they call home; and

WHEREAS, one such organization is Dogwood Arts, which celebrated its seventieth anniversary in 2025, marking seven decades of arts advocacy, environmental stewardship, and economic impact in East Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, the seeds for Dogwood Arts were planted in 1955, when members of the Knoxville Garden Club, led by Betsey Creekmore, Martha Ashe, and Betsy Goodson, along with a group of concerned citizens with a vision began a civic beautification project—the Dogwood Trails; and

WHEREAS, the organization's premier event, the Dogwood Arts Festival, was first held in 1961, with Bob Hope attending in 1970; the festival marked half a century of celebrating the arts in 2010; and

WHEREAS, the House and Garden Show was established in 1978, and the following year saw the establishment of A Very Special Arts Festival; the organization's other banner events include Chalk Walk, Rhythm N' Blooms, and Bazillion Blooms, which, since 2009, has helped plant more than 18,500 dogwood trees; and

WHEREAS, in honor of its seventieth anniversary, Dogwood Arts is highlighting its annual Bazillion Blooms campaign, selling disease-resistant, April-blooming dogwood trees to help preserve the region's natural beauty and "Keep Knoxville Blooming" for generations to come; and

WHEREAS, Dogwood Arts has enriched the arts and culture of Knoxville and beautified the city for seven decades, and it is fitting that the organization be honored; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Dogwood Arts upon the occasion of its seventieth anniversary, extending our sincere gratitude for the good work of this organization and our best wishes for its continued success in the future.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.